

**1.13 Changing Young Lives At Jamie's Farm Fillies' Juvenile Handicap Hurdle (Premier Handicap) (GBB Race)**
**£50,000 Total Race Value RTV**
**2m**

For 4yo fillies **Weights raised** 5lb **Minimum weight** 10-2 **Penalties** after April 18th, each hurdle won 7lb **Penalty value** 1st £28,475 2nd £10,685 3rd £5,350 4th £2,665 5th £1,340 6th £670

**GOOD**

|                                                                                     | Trainer                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Jockey                                     | SP         | OR         | TS         | RPR        |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
|    | <b>La Luna Artista</b> 4 12-0<br>Developing into a useful filly and readily landed the Adonis (2m, good to soft; Grade 2) at Kempton most recently, taking record to 3-4; the class angle on handicap debut and has earned top weight; respected. | Mrs J Williams<br>Ciaran Gethings          | <b>5-4</b> | <b>125</b> | 95         | 116        |
|    | <b>Made U Blush</b> 4 11-7<br>Successful in final Flat attempt and is 2-3 over hurdles for new yard, most recently bagging Listed honours at Musselburgh; one for the shortlist, with further progress plausible.                                 | D Skelton<br>Harry Skelton                 | 4-1        | 118        | 92         | 117        |
|    | <b>Love Sonnet</b> 4 11-3<br>Had her limitations exposed to some extent at Haydock last time when bidding for a hat-trick; questionable whether she'll be ahead of her mark in this first handicap hurdle attempt.                                | T Vaughan<br>James Davies                  | 12-1       | 114        | 112        | 116        |
|    | <b>Cloaks Of Gold</b> 4 11-1t<br>Had further wind surgery prior to Stratford success (2m2f, soft) last time, beating a solid yardstick in clearcut fashion and taking hurdles record to 2-3; improving in this sphere and looks one to consider.  | M Comley<br>David Bass                     | 7-1        | 112        | <b>118</b> | 116        |
|    | <b>Only One Blue</b> 4 10-11p<br>Successful on debut over hurdles and has proved very consistent since, most recently a rallying second in 4yo handicap over C&D when the only filly in the field; very solid, back against her own sex.          | M Comley<br>Tom Broughton (5)              | 12-1       | 108        | 110        | 121        |
|   | <b>The Procrastinator</b> 4 10-8<br>Has shown consistent form that features two wins; ran creditably against her elders at Chepstow most recently; possibilities on handicap debut and back against her own age group.                            | Dr R Newland & J Insole<br>Charlie Hammond | 10-1       | 105        | 102        | 114        |
|  | <b>Queen Maeve</b> 4 10-5<br>Thrice-raced filly who represents notable connections and may be capable of big improvement now handicapping; interesting, even though Harry Skelton prefers stablemate Made U Blush.                                | D Skelton<br>Tristan Durrell               | 12-1       | 102        | 90         | 110        |
|  | <b>Siorai</b> 4 10-4ht<br>Has tended to take a good hold since racing over hurdles but managed to bag silver medals the last twice; in good hands and may progress now handicapping, especially if settling better.                               | H Derham<br>Paul O'Brien                   | 10-1       | 101        | 112        | <b>122</b> |
|  | <b>Whitletts</b> 4 10-2h<br>Four-race maiden who left Dan Skelton prior to Chepstow last time when bouncing back from a disappointing effort; however, even off bottom weight this looks a difficult task.                                        | Harriet Dickin<br>James Best               | 40-1       | 99         | 92         | 108        |

**SPOTLIGHT VERDICT** Being a consistent sort who ran creditably against males over C&D most recently, **ONLY ONE BLUE** holds particularly solid claims and is one half of a robust hand for Max Comley, who is also represented by the improving **Cloaks Of Gold** (second choice). **Made U Blush** and **Queen Maeve** give Dan Skelton a respectable hand, while **La Luna Artista** is the class angle and a couple of the others also have possibilities in a competitive opener.[Steve Boow]

**1.45 bet365 Novices' Championship Final Handicap Hurdle (GBB****Race)****£100,000 Total Race Value ITV****2m****For 4yo+ which have been placed in the first four in a Novices' Championship Hurdle Series Qualifier during the current season.****Minimum weight 10-2 Penalties after April 18th, each hurdle won 7lb Penalty value 1st £51,440 2nd £23,650 3rd £11,830 4th £5,910 5th £2,960 6th £1,470****GOOD**

|                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                  | Trainer      | Jockey             | SP         | OR         | TS         | RPR        |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|--------------|--------------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
|                                                                                                                        | <b>Cosmic Connection</b> 5 12-0  | C Gordon     | Sam Twiston-Davies | 9-2        | 129        | 123        | <b>133</b> |
| Scored in tidy fashion at Chepstow (2m, good to soft; handicap debut) last time, taking rules record to 2-3, and is probably still well treated even after a 6lb rise; improving.                       |                                  |              |                    |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                        | <b>Kadastral</b> 6 11-10         | D Skelton    | Harry Skelton      | <b>7-2</b> | 125        | 110        | 128        |
| Non-stayer over 2m4f last time; solid record at 2m otherwise, including two efforts behind smart Sober Glory; this Skelton runner likely still has more to offer; respected handicap debutant.          |                                  |              |                    |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                        | <b>Wilstar</b> 6 11-10t          | O Murphy     | Sean Bowen         | 10-1       | 125        | 106        | 127        |
| Half-brother to Douvan and Jonbon; not in their league but is progressive and has won his last two starts, latest at Warwick (2m, good to soft); enters calculations on handicap debut.                 |                                  |              |                    |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                        | <b>Kocktail Bleu</b> 6 11-10     | C Gordon     | Tom Cannon         | 10-1       | 125        | 119        | 132        |
| Proving consistent and, following a good effort in a Grade 2, he made all at Newbury (2m, good to soft) back down in class last time; far from sure to get an easy lead in this bigger field, however.  |                                  |              |                    |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                        | <b>Minella Yoga</b> 4 11-9       | P Nicholls   | Harry Cobden       | 5-1        | <b>132</b> | 108        | <b>133</b> |
| Improving 4yo whose record is 3-4; bought for £360,000 after sole Irish hurdles start; ran well in Grade 2 for sole defeat; easily justified favouritism at Taunton (2m, good) last time; major player. |                                  |              |                    |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                       | <b>Desertmore News</b> 6 11-9    | T Ellis      | Miss Gina Andrews  | 20-1       | 124        | 104        | 128        |
| Made all in small field at Sedgfield (2m1f, good) last time, taking hurdles record to 2-3; however, he faces a stiffer task in this deep handicap with competition for the lead.                        |                                  |              |                    |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                      | <b>Next Twist</b> 6 11-6h        | O Murphy     | NON-RUNNER         |            | 121        | 111        | 132        |
| Made all in small field at Ayr (2m, soft) last time, taking hurdles record to 2-4; in good hands and may do better still but dominating this race seems likely to be harder.                            |                                  |              |                    |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                      | <b>Last Round</b> 5 11-5         | B Pauling    | Ben Jones          | 16-1       | 120        | 81         | 121        |
| Finished behind Kadastral on penultimate start but may fare better in this rematch, having scored comfortably in Fontwell maiden (2m1f, good to soft) latest; further progress is possible.             |                                  |              |                    |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                      | <b>Race To Base</b> 6 11-3w t    | N Scholfield | Jack Quinlan       | 33-1       | 118        | <b>124</b> | 131        |
| Had wind surgery since failing to convince over 2m4f in the EBF Final on this track last time on stable debut; return to 2m looks a plus but he's still seeking first rules win away from Hereford.     |                                  |              |                    |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                      | <b>Kapitein Kool</b> 5 11-3      | J S Mullins  | Paul O'Brien       | 40-1       | 118        | 123        | 131        |
| Dual novice winner but came up well short at Newbury (2m3f) on handicap debut most recently and can be opposed in this competitive field.                                                               |                                  |              |                    |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                      | <b>Bespoke Tailor</b> 6 11-3w t  | O Signy      | Gavin Sheehan      | 25-1       | 118        | 118        | 130        |
| Has consistent hurdles form; however, his chance of gaining a first success in this sphere largely depends on how well he responds to a physical tweak (wind surgery since last run).                   |                                  |              |                    |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                      | <b>Dutch Corner</b> 5 11-3ht     | D Skelton    | Tristan Durrell    | 16-1       | 118        | <b>124</b> | 127        |
| Posted consistent efforts prior to ready win in Newton Abbot maiden (2m2f, good to soft) last time; may improve further and can't be dismissed, even though Harry Skelton prefers Kadastral.            |                                  |              |                    |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                      | <b>Ambiente Friendly</b> 5 11-2h | J Owen       | Jonathan Burke     | 33-1       | 117        | 101        | 125        |
| Showed smart Flat form as a 3yo; managed to win in December but has otherwise broadly been too free for his own good since switched to hurdles; ideally needs to settle better.                         |                                  |              |                    |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                      | <b>Legal Weapon</b> 6 11-0t      | B Pauling    | Brendan Powell     | 33-1       | 115        | 100        | 126        |
| Reasonably consistent but is 0-5 over hurdles, finishing fourth to Wilstar at Warwick most recently; chance of finding the necessary progress largely depends on the effects of first-time tongue-tie.  |                                  |              |                    |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                      | <b>Stanners Glen</b> 7 10-9t     | H Fry        | Bryan Carver       | 16-1       | 110        | 104        | 127        |
| Made all in Wincanton maiden (1m7f, good) in latest hurdles attempt, adding to his point/bumper wins and taking overall record to 3-6; however, this scenario is much more demanding.                   |                                  |              |                    |            |            |            |            |

**Talakan** 4 10-9

T Lawes

Kevin Brogan

14-1 118 110 125

Flat winner in France and knocking at the door over hurdles for new yard, second to Wilstar at Warwick (2m) most recently; possibilities, provided he shows some progress on handicap debut.

**Secret Sniper** 5 10-9

H Morrison

Tom Bellamy

12-1 110 94 **133**

No match for Minella Yoga at Taunton, taking record to 0-6; however, he's related to several winners for his connections and may have potential off his opening mark; one to consider.

**Way Of Stars** 4 10-6h

D Pipe

Jack Tudor

16-1 115 108 132

Prevailed in second-time hood at Taunton (2m, good) most recently, adding to his Flat win, and may have more to offer in the retained headgear; in deeper waters today but could go well.

**Love You Back** 4 10-2

G &amp; J Moore

Freddie Mitchell (3)

33-1 111 114 127

Flat winner whose hurdles form comprises a couple of second-place finishes and a late fall (beaten at the time); even off bottom weight, this looks a difficult task upped in class.

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**SPOTLIGHT VERDICT** Most of the runners are handicap newcomers, many of whom could prove capable of further progress. Improving **COSMIC CONNECTION** made a successful switch to handicap level last time and is probably still ahead of the assessor. Well-bred **Wilstar** is the narrow second choice, ahead of notable juvenile **Minella Yoga** and one who ties in with him, namely **Secret Sniper**. Skelton first string **Kadastral** has to be respected, while not many others can be comfortably ruled out in a deep handicap.[Steve Boow]

**2.20 bet365 Oaksey Chase (Grade 2) (For The Menorah Challenge Trophy) (GBB Race)**
**£80,000 Total Race Value** **ITV**
**2m61/2f**

For 5yo+ which are allotted a rating or an assessment of 120 or more by the BHA Handicapper, taking account of races run up to and including the day prior to entry **Weights** 5yo 11st; 6yo+ 11st 2lb **Penalties** after September 30th, 2024, a winner of a Listed or Premier Handicap/Grade 3 chase 4lb; of a Grade 1 or Grade 2 chase 6lb; (Half penalties for wins achieved in novices' and beginners' chases in Great Britain and Ireland and 3yo only chases in France) **Penalty value** **1st** £45,560 **2nd** £17,096 **3rd** £8,560 **4th** £4,264 **5th** £2,144 **6th** £1,072

**GOOD**

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Trainer                        | Jockey      | SP               | OR   | TS  | RPR |     |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------|------------------|------|-----|-----|-----|
|                                                                                                                                                                                         | <b>Teddy Blue</b> 8 11-6tb     | H Derham    | Paul O'Brien     | 25-1 | 135 | 140 | 146 |
| Has registered a couple of useful handicap wins this season, including at Kempton (2m4f, good) on penultimate start; faces a stiffer task conceding weight all round in this grade, with 4lb penalty incurred.                                                           |                                |             |                  |      |     |     |     |
|                                                                                                                                                                                         | <b>Blow Your Wad</b> 8 11-2tp  | G & J Moore | Freddie Mitchell | 7-4  | 151 | 150 | 163 |
| Has shown good form for new stable, mostly in handicaps, including at the Cheltenham Festival (3m1f); defied top weight at Chepstow (2m3f, good to soft) most recently, looking better than ever; leading chance at the weights in his bid for a second Grade 2 success. |                                |             |                  |      |     |     |     |
|                                                                                                                                                                                         | <b>Doyen Quest</b> 8 11-2      | D Skelton   | Harry Skelton    | 15-8 | 143 | 142 | 158 |
| Useful novice chaser whose form features second-place finishes in 3m Grade 2 events at Sandown and Windsor; came up rather short in Grade 1 at Aintree last time but looks one of the main contenders returned to this level.                                            |                                |             |                  |      |     |     |     |
|                                                                                                                                                                                         | <b>Etalon</b> 9 11-2tp         | D Skelton   | Tristan Durrell  | 9-1  | 144 | 158 | 161 |
| Form since wearing cheekpieces includes good performances (career-best form) at Ascot, winning over 2m3f then third over 2m5f (good to soft and soft); may rebound from a lesser effort last time but Harry Skelton prefers stablemate Doyen Quest.                      |                                |             |                  |      |     |     |     |
|                                                                                                                                                                                         | <b>Mahons Glory</b> 10 11-2    | D Cunha     | Lee Edwards      | 16-1 | 139 | 148 | 156 |
| Broadly consistent in handicaps for current yard and ran respectably in the Topham at Aintree (2m5f) most recently; made all, despite jumping left, at Huntingdon (2m4f; also on good to soft) the time before; this is a harder task.                                   |                                |             |                  |      |     |     |     |
|                                                                                                                                                                                       | <b>Matterhorn</b> 8 11-2t      | P Nicholls  | Harry Cobden     | 7-2  | 146 | 147 | 162 |
| Chase record is 5-11, the most recent win at Uttoxeter (2m4f, good) last spring; seen only twice since but ran well in a notable handicap at Plumpton (2m1f) the latest time; possibilities at the weights, provided he stays the new trip.                              |                                |             |                  |      |     |     |     |
|                                                                                                                                                                                       | <b>Ventura Highway</b> 6 11-2p | G & J Moore | Caolin Quinn     | 33-1 | 129 | -   | 138 |
| Formerly trained in France; recorded a chase win at Auteuil (2m6f) last May but has failed to repeat the form since; has the worst chance on RPRs in this British debut.                                                                                                 |                                |             |                  |      |     |     |     |

**SPOTLIGHT VERDICT** Solid-looking **BLOW YOUR WAD** has the best chance in a substandard edition of this prize. **Doyen Quest** (second pick) and **Matterhorn** appear to be the biggest dangers.[Steve Boow]

**2.55 bet365 Celebration Chase (Grade 1) (GBB Race)****£175,000** Total Race Value **ITV****1m71/2f**

For 5yo+ which are allotted a rating or an assessment of 130 or more by the BHA Handicapper, taking account of races run up to and including the day prior to entry **Weights** 11st 10lb **Penalty value** 1st £99,662.50 2nd £37,397.50 3rd £18,725 4th £9,327.50 5th £4,690 6th £2,345

**GOOD**

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                              | Trainer           | Jockey             | SP         | OR         | TS         | RPR        |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------|--------------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>Brookie</b> 9 11-10t      | A Honeyball       | Sam Twiston-Davies | 66-1       | 141        | 142        | 152        |
| Has proved difficult to place since last win in March 2025 and form has taken a downturn of late; has the worst chance at the weights back up in class.                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                              |                   |                    |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>Edwardstone</b> 12 11-10  | A King            | Tom Cannon         | 33-1       | 150        | 131        | 162        |
| Admirable veteran, albeit isn't quite the force of old and gained this season's win in substandard Grade 2 at Kempton (2m4f); also perhaps ideally suited by further than about 2m nowadays; beaten twice in this race.                                                                                                                                                            |                              |                   |                    |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>Jonbon</b> 10 11-10p      | N Henderson       | Nico de Boinville  | <b>6-4</b> | <b>165</b> | 163        | 173        |
| Multiple Grade 1 winner whose excellent record at Sandown includes form figures of 112 in this contest; perhaps ideally needs further now, having been upped to 2m5f for the second leg of this season's Ascot double, then posted a Ryanair effort (2m4f) that took his Cheltenham Festival form figures to 2222; leading player provided the drop back in trip doesn't backfire. |                              |                   |                    |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>Jpr One</b> 9 11-10tp     | J Tizzard         | Brendan Powell     | 16-1       | 159        | 153        | 168        |
| Form since upped to 2m4f comprises a handicap win at Musselburgh and fourth-place finishes in Grade 1 events at Cheltenham and Aintree; return to shorter may not be an issue but he ideally needs a drop back in class.                                                                                                                                                           |                              |                   |                    |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>Mirabad</b> 7 11-10t      | D Skelton         | Tristan Durrell    | 12-1       | 155        | 142        | 162        |
| Belied his 50-1 odds with 6l success in Grade 1 novice chase at Aintree (2m, good to soft) two weeks ago; however, needs to prove he can back up that form and Harry Skelton prefers solid stablemate Thistle Ask.                                                                                                                                                                 |                              |                   |                    |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | <b>Solness</b> 8 11-10tp     | J P O'Brien (IRE) | J J Slevin         | 7-2        | <b>165</b> | <b>168</b> | <b>174</b> |
| Smart front-runner whose Grade 1 form features three wins at Leopardstown (2m1f) in 2024/2025 and neck second, showing career-best form, at Aintree (2m4f, good to soft) on latest start; one of the main contenders back down in distance.                                                                                                                                        |                              |                   |                    |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | <b>Thistle Ask</b> 9 11-10ht | D Skelton         | Harry Skelton      | 7-4        | 160        | 159        | 169        |
| Front-runner who has shown excellent progress over fences and whose record for current stable reads 11112, the last two wins in Grade 2 handicaps; collared by Jonbon in soft-ground Grade 1 at Ascot (2m1f) when last seen; may turn the tables returned to forecast ideal ground, being 5-5 on good; possibly hasn't reached his ceiling yet; respected.                         |                              |                   |                    |            |            |            |            |

**SPOTLIGHT VERDICT** Back on good ground, **THISTLE ASK** is taken to reverse Clarence House placings at Ascot with **Jonbon** who nevertheless commands respect as usual, despite a slight concern that he perhaps needs a stiffer test than this now. **Solness**, who looks set to dispute the pace with the selection, is the other main player.[Steve Boow]

**3.30 bet365 Gold Cup Handicap Chase (Premier Handicap) (GBB****Race)****£175,000 Total Race Value****3m41/2f**

For 5yo+ Minimum weight 10-2 Penalties (no penalties after publication of the weights) Penalty value 1st £98,472.50 2nd £37,100  
 3rd £18,567.50 4th £9,275 5th £4,655 6th £2,327.50

**GOOD**

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Trainer                                     | Jockey          | SP              | OR   | TS         | RPR            |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|-----------------|-----------------|------|------------|----------------|
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>Resplendent Grey</b> 8 12-0p             | O Murphy        | Sean Bowen      | 12-1 | <b>152</b> | 133 156        |
| Won this race (good ground) last year in first-time cheekpieces off a 10lb lower mark; first and second in two small fields this season, alongside two heavy defeats in top handicaps; tried blinkers when fading right out of it at the Cheltenham Festival last time and now reverts to cheekpieces; also back on firmer ground but a new career best is needed.                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                             |                 |                 |      |            |                |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>Henry's Friend</b> 9 11-6tp <sup>1</sup> | B Pauling       | Ben Jones       | 16-1 | 144        | 131 158        |
| Seems best making the running or racing prominently; his six races in the last 14 months have been a mixed bag, with an Ascot win (3m, good) in November the highlight; just 1lb higher today and ran respectably on penultimate start, but his two earlier attempts at 3m6f/4m did not work out; a tongue-tie (worn twice in 2023, with a win on first occasion) returns.                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                             |                 |                 |      |            |                |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>Rock My Way</b> 8 11-0tb                 | J Tizzard       | Brendan Powell  | 14-1 | 138        | 141 161        |
| 2-14 record over fences includes some big runs, including when he hacked up at Ascot (3m5f, good) in November and took second in the Midlands National at Uttoxeter (4m2f, soft) on latest outing; the Ascot race was going this way round but so was his penultimate start when he kept jumping to his left at Musselburgh (12l second to Transmission); that's a niggling concern but he's handicapped to go well if this is another good day.                                                                                                                                   |                                             |                 |                 |      |            |                |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>Road To Home</b> 7 10-13                 | W Mullins (IRE) | Mr P W Mullins  | 7-1  | 137        | 138 157        |
| He was set to be the only Willie Mullins runner in last week's Scottish National but was withdrawn due to the heavy ground; 7yo who was delivered with what seemed a winning challenge under Patrick Mullins in the Kim Muir at Cheltenham (3m2f, good; furthest he's been) six weeks ago only to find that Ask Brewster battled back; up 6lb but has to be in serious calculations.                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                             |                 |                 |      |            |                |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | <b>Transmission</b> 9 10-13v                | N Mulholland    | Conor O'Farrell | 16-1 | 137        | 140 158        |
| Tapped back into last season's initial promising form, and then some, to win by 12l in the Edinburgh National at Musselburgh (3m7f, good to soft; from Rock My Way) in February with a first-time visor, which has been kept since; ridden by 7lb claimer when fair third off this 8lb higher mark behind Havaila in the Sussex National at Plumpton 19 days ago but needs to hit new heights again.                                                                                                                                                                               |                                             |                 |                 |      |            |                |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | <b>Our Power</b> 11 10-13b <sup>1</sup>     | S Thomas        | Dylan Johnston  | 20-1 | 137        | 106 155        |
| Withdrawn from Scottish National last week due to the heavy ground; 6lb lower than this time last year (when third in the Scottish National) as he's not fired on all cylinders this term, but excuses can be made; he's won two major 3m handicaps going right-handed (Ascot and Kempton) on good ground, back in the 2022-23 season admittedly but this 11yo may be dangerous to dismiss, including as first-time blinkers replace his usual cheekpieces.                                                                                                                        |                                             |                 |                 |      |            |                |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | <b>In D'Or</b> 8 10-13                      | F O'Brien       | Jonathan Burke  | 5-1  | 137        | 137 159        |
| 3m6f for the NH Chase at Cheltenham last March was his only attempt beyond 3m and he was below form; that was also his last run for Venetia Williams (bought for £220,000 in October at the David Maxwell dispersal) and he's been a good third this winter in 3m handicaps here and at Ascot; needs to build on that, as he's edging up the weights, but he's not fully exposed.                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                             |                 |                 |      |            |                |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | <b>Certainly Red</b> 12 10-13p              | Lydia Richards  | Marc Goldstein  | 25-1 | 137        | 145 154        |
| Seventh in this race in 2023 and fourth on good ground in 2024; missed all of 2025 and although he ran encouragingly on reappearance here (3m, soft; 50-1) seven weeks ago, still disputing the lead when making a mess of the second last, others have more pressing claims.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                             |                 |                 |      |            |                |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | <b>Havaila</b> 7 10-11                      | G & J Moore     | Caolin Quinn    | 9-2  | 135        | 137 159        |
| A rising force in the last 15 months and that's gained serious momentum in his last two starts, when winning easily by 7l at Newbury (extended 2m7f, good to soft) and 5l in the Sussex National at Plumpton (3m5f, good); strong-travelling sort who's now seeing out his races really well too; up another 10lb but could still have more in the locker.                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                             |                 |                 |      |            |                |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | <b>Ask Brewster</b> 7 10-11                 | Mrs C Williams  | Mr S Cotter (7) | 7-1  | 135        | 134 156        |
| 3m4f resulted in an 8l win at Cheltenham last April and he's won over 3m/3m2f in two of his three starts this season; latest was the Kim Muir at Cheltenham in which he was always front rank under Shane Cotter and responded admirably when Road To Home joined him on the run-in; up 7lb but this trip makes plenty of appeal and all five chase wins have been on good ground or good to firm (withdrawn from Scottish National last week due to the heavy); has a bit to prove going right-handed, with a run here in December prompting concern, but otherwise lots to like. |                                             |                 |                 |      |            |                |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | <b>Montregard</b> 7 10-8v                   | T Lacey         | Stan Sheppard   | 4-1  | 132        | <b>150 162</b> |
| Half-brother to top-class Protektorat; withdrawn from Scottish National last week due to the heavy going; made three notable steps forward on varied ground over 3m at Ascot (unraced here) this season, including for a good prize on latest start when he led two out for a clearcut win; raised another 4lb but he's firmly on the upgrade, likely to prove well handicapped if he gets this trip, which is also feasible; a bold show is on its way.                                                                                                                           |                                             |                 |                 |      |            |                |

**Gabbys Cross** 11 10-7p

N Scholfield

Jack Tudor

66-1 131 132 156

Ex-Irish 11yo (six races for current yard) who has not won since 2022 but went close with first-time cheekpieces (kept since) over 3m2f at Newbury in February; second of three at Ascot (3m) in another veterans' race next time was creditable in the end, after he'd been detached at one point; that helps to envisage him as a stayer but he jumped poorly on heavy in Scottish National (40-1, pulled up) last week and this race also looks tough.

**Livin On Luco** 8 10-5b

P Hobbs &amp; J White

Sean Houlihan

12-1 129 144 156

Failed to fire in the Eider at Newcastle on penultimate start; commendable otherwise this season, making all in the Southern National at Fontwell (3m3f, good to soft), fourth in Welsh Grand National at Chepstow (3m7f, good to soft) and short-headed at Exeter (3m7f, good) five weeks ago; raised another 2lb but has place claims.

**Invincible Nao** 8 10-2h

G &amp; J Moore

Tom Cannon

25-1 126 138 152

Won Sussex National at Plumpton (extended 3m4f, soft) last February in his first long-distance race but less convincing since in forays over 4m2f, C&D and 3m5f; had a small-field 2m4f win on good ground here in November but this race, from 2lb out of the handicap, demands a big personal best.

**SPOTLIGHT VERDICT** Three of the market leaders were declared to contest last Saturday's Scottish National but did not do so when the ground turned heavy. This time it's the right-handed track which might inconvenience **Ask Brewster**, who makes plenty of appeal on other counts but lugged out to his left here in December. The vote therefore goes to **MONTREGARD (nap)** who stamped his authority on two Ascot handicaps this season in highly encouraging fashion. **Road To Home** also needs to prove his stamina but represents Willie Mullins and ran Ask Brewster close over 3m2f at Cheltenham. **Havaila** and **In d'Or**, who were not declared for the Scottish National, are among those disputing favouritism and Havaila can give the selection most to think about judged on the way he's come good in such splendid style for two wins in the last five weeks.[Richard Austen]

**4.02 bet365 Select Hurdle (Grade 2) (GBB Race)****£80,000 Total Race Value** **RTV****2m51/2f**

**For** 4yo+ which are allotted a rating or an assessment of 120 or more by the BHA Handicapper, taking account of races run up to and including the day prior to entry **Weights** 4yo 10st 8lb; 5yo+ 11st 4lb **Penalties** after September 30th, 2024 a winner of a Listed or Premier Handicap/Grade 3 hurdle 4lb; of a Grade 1 or Grade 2 hurdle 6lb; (Half penalties for wins achieved in novices' or juvenile hurdles in Great Britain and Ireland or 3yo only hurdles in France) **Penalty value** 1st £45,560 2nd £17,096 3rd £8,560 4th £4,264 5th £2,144 6th £1,072

**GOOD**

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Trainer                          | Jockey            | SP                | OR         | TS         | RPR        |            |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
|                                                                                                                                                                                                             | <b>Kabral Du Mathan</b> 6 11-10t | D Skelton         | Harry Skelton     | <b>4-9</b> | <b>156</b> | <b>153</b> | <b>162</b> |
| An exciting force since joining current stable and sent beyond 2m, gaining impressive wins at Haydock (2m3f handicap) and Cheltenham (2m4f Grade 2) then shaping like the best horse in the Grade 1 Stayers' Hurdle (3m) until his tank emptied late on; the one to beat, back down in trip. |                                  |                   |                   |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                             | <b>Lucky Place</b> 7 11-10       | N Henderson       | Nico de Boinville | 11-1       | 151        | 132        | 155        |
| Dual Grade 2 winner last term; finished third at the same level on penultimate start but was behind Kabral Du Mathan and stablemate Jingko Blue in that Cheltenham race; seems set for another bronze medal at best.                                                                         |                                  |                   |                   |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                             | <b>Rubaud</b> 8 11-10            | P Nicholls        | Harry Cobden      | 14-1       | 145        | 143        | 154        |
| Form dipped in Cheltenham Festival handicap returned to fences last time; multiple Grade 2 winner but has raced mostly at about 2m and isn't crying out for this step back up in trip; first go beyond a sharp 2m4f.                                                                         |                                  |                   |                   |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                             | <b>Jingko Blue</b> 7 11-8        | N Henderson       | James Bowen       | 11-2       | 153        | 145        | 160        |
| Has shown good form over 2m4f/2m5f at Cheltenham this term, finishing second to Kabral Du Mathan in Grade 2 and recording an emphatic success from the front in Festival handicap; failed to get home in 3m Grade 1 at Aintree last time; one of the main contenders, back down in distance. |                                  |                   |                   |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                             | <b>Altobelli</b> 8 11-4tp        | H Fry             | Bryan Carver      | 12-1       | 144        | 135        | 157        |
| Completed a 2m3f handicap double at Ascot last season; best effort since when second in useful event at Windsor (2m4f) on last appearance, leaving the impression today's scenario will prove ideal; could go well.                                                                          |                                  |                   |                   |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                           | <b>French Ship</b> 6 11-4        | P Hobbs & J White | Ben Jones         | 14-1       | 146        | 145        | 158        |
| Form has gone rather awry in last three outings but he has been progressive otherwise, culminating in 2m4f handicap wins at Cheltenham and Newbury in the autumn; may rebound and run a good race.                                                                                           |                                  |                   |                   |            |            |            |            |

**SPOTLIGHT VERDICT** Back down in distance, **KABRAL DU MATHAN** should prove very difficult to beat. **Jingko Blue** may well finish second to repeat the Relkeel result. **Altobelli** is third pick with this scenario likely to suit.[Steve Boow]

**4.40 bet365 Josh Gifford Novices' Handicap Chase (GBB Race)****£40,000** Total Race Value **RTV****2m4f**For 5yo+ **Weights raised** 8lb **Minimum weight** 10-2 **Penalties** after April 18th, each chase won 5lb **Penalty value** 1st £20,812 2nd £9,568 3rd £4,784 4th £2,392 5th £1,196**GOOD**

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Trainer                  | Jockey                   | SP                | OR         | TS         | RPR        |            |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|-------------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | <b>Go West</b> 8 12-0    | P Nicholls               | Freddie Gingell   | 7-2        | <b>139</b> | <b>132</b> | 141        |
| Didn't jump well enough when well beaten in Kempton Grade 2 novice in February last time but had doubled his chasing tally with ready success at Musselburgh (2m4f, good to soft) three weeks earlier, and will be dangerous if back in similar form.                                                                          |                          |                          |                   |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | <b>Millforce</b> 7 11-7p | H Oliver                 | Lee Edwards       | 16-1       | 132        | 111        | 138        |
| Signed off for Gavin Cromwell in Ireland with hard-fought win at Galway (2m6f, yielding) in the autumn but was pulled up when reappearing for new stable at Haydock (3m1f, good to soft) ten days ago and needs to turn things around quickly.                                                                                 |                          |                          |                   |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | <b>Calimystic</b> 7 11-3 | N Henderson              | Nico de Boinville | <b>6-4</b> | 128        | 129        | 141        |
| Low-mileage 7yo who is 2-2 over fences, the latter win gained here (3m, soft) last month; recently withdrawn with good ground deemed unsuitable but his first two wins (one over hurdles) were gained on good; should cope with this drop back in trip and has plenty of scope for further progress; respected.                |                          |                          |                   |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | <b>Palamon</b> 6 10-10t  | D Skelton                | Harry Skelton     | 11-4       | 121        | 113        | <b>142</b> |
| Returned to form and rewarded heavy market support at Bangor (2m4f, good; tongue-tie refitted) last month, his fifth start for Dan Skelton; just a respectable sixth under penalty in the Red Rum at Aintree (2m, good to soft) nine days later and his mark is another 5lb higher here, but he remains very much of interest. |                          |                          |                   |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | <b>Kahavari</b> 6 10-4t  | O Greenall & J Guerriero | Jack Tudor        | 5-1        | 115        | 129        | 141        |
| 0-13 since winning over hurdles on debut in France in 2024; runner-up in three chases since fitted with a tongue-tie this year, most recently at Kelso (2m7f, good) three weeks ago, but he is 3lb higher in a stronger race here and needs to find something extra.                                                           |                          |                          |                   |            |            |            |            |

**SPOTLIGHT VERDICT** The drop back to 2m didn't pay dividends at Aintree but **PALAMON** appeared to have plenty in hand when landing a big punt over 2m4f at Bangor two starts ago and is taken to overcome a 10lb higher mark today. **Calimystic** has made a bright start to his chasing career and is an obvious danger, while **Go West** can feature if back on song after his Grade 2 disappointment. [Chris Wilson]

**5.15 bet365 Handicap Hurdle (GBB Race)****£35,000 Total Race Value RTV****2m4f**For 4yo+ Rated 0-145 (also open to such horses rated 146 and 147 - see Standard Conditions)  
April 18th, each hurdle won 6lb**Minimum weight 10-2** **Penalties after**  
**Penalty value 1st £18,210.50 2nd £8,372 3rd £4,186 4th £2,093 5th £1,046.50 6th £521.50****GOOD**

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                  | Trainer     | Jockey                  | SP         | OR         | TS         | RPR        |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|-------------|-------------------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
|                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <b>Favour And Fortune</b> 8 12-0 | A King      | Tom Bellamy             | 6-1        | <b>143</b> | 133        | 144        |
| Seen only twice this season but posted career-best performance when close third of 22 at Aintree (2m4f, good to soft) a fortnight ago, despite Tom Bellamy's saddle slipping after the last; respected.                                                                              |                                  |             |                         |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <b>Dargiannini</b> 11 11-9t      | H Derham    | Paul O'Brien            | 50-1       | 138        | 100        | 142        |
| Returned from a break with narrow win at Uttoxter (2m4f, good) in October but pulled up on both starts since, latterly at last month's Cheltenham Festival; younger rivals have much more persuasive profiles.                                                                       |                                  |             |                         |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <b>Aurigny Mill</b> 9 11-8p      | R Walford   | Harry Kimber            | 25-1       | 137        | 123        | 145        |
| Seemingly back in prime form when clear winner at Taunton (2m, heavy) in February; also suited by good ground and stays at least 2m3f but he disappointed on latest outing and others in this field look better handicapped.                                                         |                                  |             |                         |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <b>Listentoyourheart</b> 7 10-13 | D Skelton   | Harry Skelton           | 13-2       | 128        | 131        | 143        |
| Just held on to land big prize at Windsor (2m4f, good) on New Year's Day but wasn't in quite the same form on next two outings (2m3f/3m) and probably needs to find hidden reserves.                                                                                                 |                                  |             |                         |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <b>Trustintimes</b> 5 10-12      | H Fry       | Bryan Carver            | 11-1       | 127        | 120        | 146        |
| 3-5 over hurdles, the latest win gained at Ascot (1m7f, good) in November; never really got involved when upped to 2m4f at Aintree a fortnight ago but could plausibly still have untapped potential over this trip.                                                                 |                                  |             |                         |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                    | <b>Authorised Speed</b> 9 10-12  | G & J Moore | Freddie Mitchell (3)    | 33-1       | 127        | -          | -          |
| Dual 2m winner here; absent since finishing fifth in a beginners' chase in May 2024 but was placed off mark 7lb higher than today's in this race two years ago (good ground); worth a glance in the market.                                                                          |                                  |             |                         |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>Last Kingdom</b> 5 10-10p     | F Bramley   | Harry Cobden            | 28-1       | 125        | 125        | 141        |
| Won big-field Listed handicap in first-time cheekpieces at Listowel (2m, good to yielding) for Willie Mullins in September; badly out of form for new stable this year (four runs) but may fare better now that the cheekpieces are reinstated.                                      |                                  |             |                         |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>Lucky Manifest</b> 6 10-7w t  | T Lacey     | Stan Sheppard           | 20-1       | 122        | <b>139</b> | 146        |
| Started off for new stable in excellent form in the autumn, winning at Kelso (2m6f, good) before big-field second at Cheltenham (2m5f, soft), but his progress has stalled a bit since; needs combination of last month's wind up and first-time tongue-tie to have positive effect. |                                  |             |                         |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>Fasol</b> 7 10-5tp            | P Nicholls  | Miss Olive Nicholls (5) | 12-1       | 120        | 135        | <b>148</b> |
| Largely consistent 7yo who recovered from a jumping error at third-last flight to take fourth in Sussex Champion Hurdle at Plumpton (2m, good) there weeks ago; also suited by 2m4f and this track; considered each-way.                                                             |                                  |             |                         |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>Gnomon</b> 5 10-5             | T Lawes     | Tom Cannon              | <b>7-2</b> | 120        | 119        | 143        |
| Fairly useful Flat racer; runner-up on first three hurdle starts (all 2m) before cruising clear in four-runner Ascot maiden (2m3f, good) last month; could easily have more improvement to come in handicap hurdles; interesting.                                                    |                                  |             |                         |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>No Ordinary Joe</b> 10 10-5tv | F Bramley   | Richie McLernon         | 12-1       | 120        | 130        | 144        |
| Kept on for sixth of 21 in first-time visor at Aintree (2m, good to soft) a fortnight ago and will be suited by this move back up in trip, but his last win came in 2022 and he's patently not the force of old.                                                                     |                                  |             |                         |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>Across Earth</b> 5 10-3       | G & J Moore | Caolin Quinn            | 5-1        | 118        | 125        | 145        |
| Won against his own age-group here (2m, soft; also suited by good) in December and has finished close up on all three outings since (1m7f-2m); must be considered on this first attempt at 2m4f.                                                                                     |                                  |             |                         |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>Joltin N Jiving</b> 6 10-3t   | D McCain    | NON-RUNNER              |            | 118        | 112        | 143        |
| Non-runner.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                  |             |                         |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>Surrey Lord</b> 7 10-2        | T Lawes     | Kevin Brogan            | 6-1        | 117        | 135        | 145        |
| Made good progress towards end of 2025, with latest of three wins gained at Kempton (2m5f, good) on Boxing Day; not discredited when fourth at Ascot (2m3f, soft) in January and has good claims if tuned up after a break.                                                          |                                  |             |                         |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>Royal Way</b> 6 10-2p         | G & J Moore | Sean Houlihan           | 10-1       | 117        | 114        | 144        |
| Exploited reduced mark when winning quite comfortably at Ludlow last month and was one of two to pull clear of the others when second at Ascot (also 2m5f, good) ten days later; no surprise if he features.                                                                         |                                  |             |                         |            |            |            |            |

**Tour Ovalie** 7 10-2

Mrs C Williams

Sean Bowen

16-1 117 124 145

Gained all six hurdle wins at around 2m but ran quite well when fourth at Chepstow (2m3f, soft) last month; current mark is workable (even from 1lb out of the weights) and Sean Bowen takes over today; could have a say.

**SPOTLIGHT VERDICT** The last race of the season can go to **GNOMON**. Toby Lawes's 5yo beat only three rivals when winning an Ascot maiden last month but he did so stylishly, and the form was given a good boost when the runner-up won a Ludlow handicap on Wednesday. **Surrey Lord** could still be well treated after his Kempton win on Boxing Day and is feared most. **Favour And Fortune** ran a big race at Aintree two weeks ago and is next on the list ahead of **Across Earth**, while the latter's long-absent stablemate **Authorised Speed** is well handicapped if he's still as good as he was.[Chris Wilson]